

P4. Who Gets the Blame? — computational analysis of public discourse on the fuel shock

Question. How are responsibility and fairness framed in Bangla-language public discourse about fuel between 2022 and 2026? Which frames predict offline protest?

Design. - **Corpus:** - Bangla and English news (Prothom Alo, Daily Star, TBS, Jugantor, Samakal, Kaler Kantho) - public Facebook pages and groups, YouTube comments on news clips, with platform terms and data-access rules followed - parliamentary debates - covering the 2022 hike, the April, June and September 2026 hikes, and the upcoming October–December 2026 events - **Methods:** - Bangla NLP: topic models, a frame classifier (global market / government failure / corruption-syndicate / India / fairness-pay scale / apology-empathy), sentiment - event data on protests (coded from news, ACLED where available) - time-series linking frame intensity to protest events and hike dates - **Validation:** human-coded sample (inter-coder reliability ≥ 0.7), plus a check against the P1 survey blame questions (the same framing categories).

Budget. Low: ~\$5–15k (RA coders, compute). The most feasible solo or remote project, and a strong companion paper to P1.